# Trump Says He Is Ending Limits on Methane From Drilling

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President Donald Trump said on Tuesday he is ending a rule from former President Joe Biden that aimed to cut methane **emissions** from oil and gas drilling. He announced it in Lubbock, Texas.

Methane is an invisible gas and the main part of natural gas. Scientists estimate it causes about a third of planet-warming **greenhouse** gas **emissions**, and it warms the air faster in the short term than carbon dioxide. Oil and gas operations are the largest industrial source of methane.

Trump said the change would save companies and consumers billions of dollars and unlock 210 million barrels of oil, about 10 days of U.S. **petroleum** use. He put the savings at $45 billion and said the Biden plan crushed small **operators** with rules.

Environmental Protection Agency Administrator Lee Zeldin previewed the changes last month. He said they would end the Super Emitter Program, which required companies to investigate and repair methane releases. Environmental groups criticized the **rollback**. Fred Krupp, president of the Environmental Defense Fund, said it gives companies a free pass at the expense of American consumers.

## Word Treasure

**emissions** -- Gases or other stuff released into the air, often from burning fuel or drilling.
**greenhouse** -- Describing gases that trap heat in the air and warm the planet.
**petroleum** -- Oil taken from the ground that is used to make fuel and other products.
**operators** -- Companies or people that run a business or a piece of equipment.
**rollback** -- Taking back or undoing a rule that was already in place.

## Background you need

Methane is a gas that can trap heat in the air and warm the planet.

It can leak out when oil and gas are drilled from the ground, so rules can require companies to find and fix those leaks.

Changing such a rule can affect both energy costs and the amount of heat-trapping gas that reaches the air.

## Break it down

**WHO:** President Donald Trump, Lee Zeldin, environmental groups, and Fred Krupp of the Environmental Defense Fund.

**WHAT:** Ending limits on methane emissions from oil and gas drilling, including the Super Emitter Program.

**WHERE:** Lubbock, Texas, where Trump announced the change.

**WHY:** Trump said the change would save money and unlock oil, while environmental groups criticized the rollback.

## Why it matters

The air you breathe and the planet you will grow up on can be affected by gases released when oil and gas are drilled.

## Test what you remember

**1. What rule did President Donald Trump say he is ending?**

(A) A rule banning data centers in Ohio
(B) A rule about ballot scanners
(C) The Super Emitter Program only
(D) A rule from former President Joe Biden that aimed to cut methane emissions from oil and gas drilling

**2. Where did Trump announce the change?**

(A) In Mt. Orab, Ohio
(B) In Fulton County, Georgia
(C) In Lubbock, Texas
(D) In Paulding County, Georgia

**3. What is methane, according to the article?**

(A) An invisible gas and the main part of natural gas
(B) A visible gas and the main part of petroleum
(C) A power plant
(D) A kind of voting machine

**4. What did the Super Emitter Program require companies to do?**

(A) Save companies and consumers billions of dollars
(B) Test every ballot
(C) Investigate and repair methane releases
(D) Unlock 210 million barrels of oil

**5. How much oil did Trump say the change would unlock?**

(A) 10 days of U.S. petroleum use
(B) A third of greenhouse gas emissions
(C) 210 million barrels
(D) 45 billion dollars

**6. What did Fred Krupp say about the rollback?**

(A) It crushed small operators with rules
(B) It would end the Super Emitter Program
(C) It would save companies and consumers billions of dollars
(D) It gives companies a free pass at the expense of American consumers

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: C 3: A 4: C 5: C 6: D

## Questions to think about

1. President Donald Trump: He said the change would save companies and consumers billions of dollars and unlock oil, and that the earlier plan crushed small operators with rules.

2. Environmental groups: They criticized the rollback.

3. Fred Krupp: He said the rollback gives companies a free pass at the expense of American consumers.

**MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):**